

Species: Purple Finch
(Vernacular name)

Carpodacus purpureus
(Scientific name)

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Date (s): 11-7-82 / 11-11-82 Time Bird Seen: Afternoon to about 15-20 min each time

Locality: Fleming, Logan County, Colorado

Nearest town, county and state: _____

Optical equipment: Leitz 7x42 ~~Leica 7x42~~

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: _____

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: Female Plumage: ~

Light conditions: Sunlight

Distance from bird, and how measured: 50 feet (estimated)

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

Feeding on wild sun flowers with flock of house finches along ditch

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

A weedy roadside along a ditch dominant species of plant - wild sun flowers

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

Inez Prather

John Prather

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of b. wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough.) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

About the same size and shape as the house finches it was with much "chirper" looking with more distinct markings - white areas much whiter - more contrast with brown areas. A very dark thick + distinct brown cheek patch + heavy "whisker". Large spots making up streaking on breast against white background. A very heavy, thick bill - reminiscent of a grosbeak, but shorter. White eye line + throat, Brown back; Notched tail.

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.:

None noted

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

Female house Finch white lines above + below cheek patch
Heavier bill, white throat + white background to breast
streaking.

Female Cassin's Finch Heavy cheek patch + whisker
Heavier Bill - lack of tendency to raise head feathers to resemble a crest that I've noted in Cassin's Finches many times but
Prior experience with this and similar species: not in Purple Finches
Purple Finches seen several times in Kansas winter of 1981-82
Long experience with house + Cassin's Finches at close range at feeder in Teller, Colo.

This report was written from notes made during ___ after ☒ observation; from memory ___.

NAME (print): Bill Prather

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Signature: Bill Prather

Return to:

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